

Tagan BZ800

Power In Colour

Although internationally they've been around for a while, Tagan is a relatively new name in the Indian market for desktop power supplies. Enter their new BZ series, a funky product line, meant for discerning users and gamers and offering some *show* to what is usually just go. The BZ series do things radically different as far as visuals go. They're modular, with pipe-like connector cables complete with circular pin arrangements (called piperock by Tagan) that ensure incompatibility with any other power supply. Then there are the cool looking LED-lit circular strips around each modular socket on the PSU that illuminate when a cable is plugged in. The cables are colour coded as per the LED colour. This ensures no mistakes while plugging in cables. If you have a transparent side window, the ensuing lighting is definitely one to get the drool out as intended. Add to that

a large cooling fan (135 mm) with blue LEDs and the BZ800 is definitely lit to kill! There is a pair of branded nylon gloves—free publicity for Tagan if you should choose to wear them around. The outer body itself is reasonably well built, but the gauge of sheet used isn't as good as the CoolerMaster Real Power 1000W or the Corsair HX series.

On the technical front the BZ800 sports six 12 volt rails. There is a Turbo mode, which disables the power limitations on the 12 V rails allowing them to overdraw power, in case you should need it. Four PCIe (two 6 pin and two 8 pin) power connectors mean SLI/Crossfire is possible with the latest cards. With a combined load capacity of 64 amps on the 12 V rail (768 W) the BZ800 is no different from other recent power supplies, which concentrate on beefing up the 12 V rail that typically powers CPUs,



that the BZ800 ran out of juice, and performed well right through.

At Rs 8,700 the Tagan BZ isn't cheap by any means, but for a high-end power supply (which it most certainly is), the price isn't too bad. The only better option we've seen is the CoolerMaster Real Power 1000W Pro—which is much costlier. Incidentally, the fact that the BZ800 is 80+ certified means your power bills will be in check. If you're looking for an extreme PC, or a super duper gaming rig, and need a powerful PSU with loads of visual appeal, you can't go wrong with this.

Specifications

800 W continuous power, 6x12 V rails, max power (12 V)—768 W (64 A), 8x SATA connectors, 2x6 pin PCIe connectors, 2x8 pin PCIe connectors, 6x peripheral connectors (4 pin)

Contact: Nanopoint Technology
Phone: +91-33-22251192
E-mail: ivan_tsai@nanopoint.com.tw
Web site: nanopoint.com.tw
Price: Rs 8,700

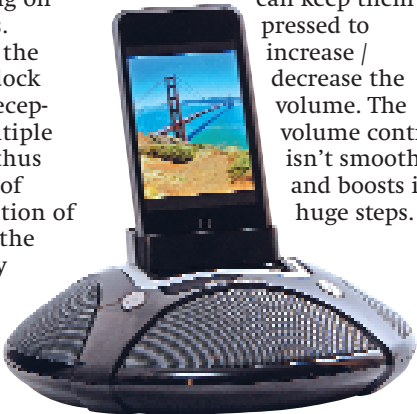
RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Supercomp Music Station SES 668

May Not Be Music To Your Ears

The SES668 Music Station is essentially an iPod dock with killer looks. The dome-shaped design looks good and the use of silver highlight on a jet black body adds that extra style—something missing on most cheap docks.

On the top of the speaker sits the dock receptacle. The receptacle accepts multiple base connectors thus allowing the use of almost all generation of iPods, expect for the newer wider body Nano. The base connector is large enough to hold most iPods in place.



On the four corners of the squares, are the buttons for powering on and volume control, and one is a dummy button. The buttons are hard to press with distinct clicks, however one can keep them pressed to increase / decrease the volume. The volume control isn't smooth and boosts in huge steps.

The dock requires 12 V and it is powered via an adapter that runs off the mains. There is no option for alternative power source like batteries, if the mains are down. The iPod can be charged via the dock and the USB connector allows it to be connected to a PC for data transfer. The dock also has an auxiliary input thus allowing an alternate sound source.

On the performance front, the dock didn't perform as per our expectation. Bass is non-existent and the drum beats often sound flat, highs are not reproduced at all and the mid-

range is completely muddled. Also there is no way to control the playback from the dock, and you will have to use the iPod.

Though affordably priced at Rs 1,350, the SES668 Music Dock isn't the right solution for your iPod. We suggest that you up the ante and invest in JBL or Bose if you care for music quality, else stick to the stock earphones.

Specifications

USB charging, USB data transfer, Auxiliary input, mobile phone compatibility and CD/DVD player.

Contact: Supertron Electronics Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-23881397
E-mail: info@supertronindia.com
Web site: www.supertronindia.com
Price: Rs 1,350

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Logitech G9

The G series Goes Modular!

Logitech's G (for gaming) series features the highest pixel count sensors, and classy aesthetics that includes grip-friendly curves, and slick-as-teflon feet for a smooth glide—something that gamers will appreciate. The G9 goes a little high tech, and includes a laser sensor that allows a whopping accuracy of 3,200 dpi. Although gamers will recognise this as marketing rubbish (no gamer worth his salt plays at even 2000 dpi), the fact remains that the sensor on the G9 is sensitive indeed. Also, onboard is the micro precision scroll wheel, which we all recognise as a clone of the excellent unit on the MX revolution, and two working modes. One you can use as a regular wheel with clicky feedback. We did mention modular—the G9 has changeable grips—the

two bundled are the regular stripped down grip and an additional bezel-like unit which clicks on to the outer body of the mouse, making it significantly wider and hence the name *wide grip*. There are also other grips that you can purchase from Logitech, each customised for a certain type of usage. From its predecessor—the G5, the G9 gets a weight cartridge, only this time it's cleverly removed by applying pressure on its notch at the rear. The weights on the G5 had a tendency to rust. Thankfully, these seem to have been adequately treated. One issue that we noticed right away (and what is possibly a major flaw) is the slight play between the weight tray and its housing—truly annoying while using the mouse. Also, if you remove the tray, you



let you know how much to dial up or dial down the DPI.

At Rs 5,995, the G9 is very expensive for the innovations and features it offers. 3,200 DPI is just gimmicky because nobody will use this mouse at that resolution. The Lachesis from Razer is another similar high DPI product (4,000 DPI) that does a better job, at a slightly higher price. The polling frequency of 1 kHz is something though, so is the ability to store and load profiles. This is a good mouse for the serious fragger, but not at its current price.

get an ugly hole at the rear of the body, whereas the G5 was neater with the tray slotting underneath the body.

Practically, the side buttons feel a little too soft, mainly because there is a slight gap between the outer body and the inner body, which has the contacts for the buttons. There is a DPI indicator (whose colour can be changed via drivers—neat but useless!), that is useful to

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Specifications

Sensor 3,200 dpi, polling frequency 1 kHz, customisable grips, customisable weights

Contact: Logitech India Pvt. Ltd
Phone: +91-22-26571160
Web site: www.logitech.com
E-mail: kavita_nath@logitech.com
Price: Rs 5,995

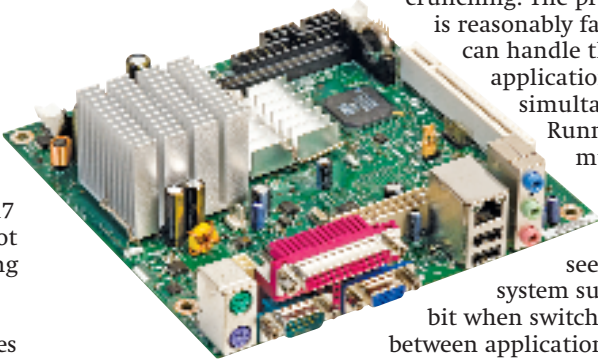
Intel D201GLY2

Honey, I Shrunk The PC!

The D201GLY2 is the cheapest motherboard-processor combo solution to come out of the Intel stable. Built to the micro ATX form factor, the motherboard is mere 17x17 cm. This combo makes a lot of sense for people building Linux nodes or low power downloading machines.

The motherboard comes with an Intel Celeron 220 processor soldered, which means no speed upgrade. The core 2-architecture based processor runs at Jurassic 1.2 GHz on a 533 MHz system bus. Thankfully, the motherboard supports DDR II, but it has single memory slot—so no dual channel for you.

Though the motherboard comes from Intel, both the chipsets are from SiS, namely, SiS662. The graphics driver for



Windows works well, but with Ubuntu 7.10 and Linux Mint 4.0, we ran into display problems and needed a patch driver for the GUI to work properly.

Other features include two SATA ports, one IDE slot, six USB ports, one serial port and one parallel port. A 10/100 Ethernet comes onboard and it has only one PCI slot.

Considering the hardware, we didn't run our

usual heavy duty tests, but instead relied on some old ones to do the number crunching. The processor is reasonably fast and can handle three applications simultaneously. Running multi-media, we could see the system suffer a bit when switching between applications. Graphic engines on the motherboard are quite weak and don't stand a chance when put to gaming. Reasonable resolution movies run fine, but high resolution ones occasionally stutter. The chipsets and processors are

passively cooled and when put to task, get really hot. We suggest going for the actively cooled model (D201GLY2A).

Priced at Rs 3,300, the D201GLY2 offers excellent value and if you want to build a compact, low cost machine, the 201GLY2 is definitely the solution to go for. However, don't expect to run games or any other heavy duty application. We suggest this for building a downloading machine, a print server or a file server.

Specifications

17x17 cm size, Celeron 1.2 GHz, supports DDR II up to 667 MHz, ADI AD1888 Audio (2 channel), 2 SATA ports and 10/100 Ethernet.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Contact: SES technologies Ltd.
Phone: +91-80-28542105
E-mail: apacsupport@mailbox.intel.com
Web site: www.intel.com
Price: Rs 3,300